

REQUEST FOR TENDER (RFT)

Procurement of an AI-Based Budget Estimation and Document Automation Platform

Reference: RFT-2026-017

Issue Date: 12 June 2026

Closing Date: 10 July 2026

1. Introduction

ABC Infrastructure Ltd. invites qualified suppliers to submit proposals for the design, development, implementation, and support of an Artificial Intelligence platform to improve the preparation of project budgets, tender documentation, and internal workflow automation.

The selected supplier will work closely with our Budgeting, Procurement, and IT departments.

2. Background

ABC Infrastructure manages more than 500 construction and engineering tenders annually.

Current processes involve:

- Manual review of technical specifications
- Spreadsheet-based cost estimation
- Manual preparation of procurement documents
- Repetitive data entry between multiple systems

The organisation intends to implement AI-assisted workflows to increase productivity and reduce errors.

3. Project Objectives

The successful supplier shall develop a solution capable of:

- Reading tender documentation (PDF, Word, Excel)
- Extracting technical requirements
- Suggesting budget estimates
- Identifying missing information
- Generating draft procurement documents

- Integrating with Microsoft 365
 - Providing audit logs
 - Supporting human review before publication
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4. Scope of Work

The supplier will be responsible for:

Phase 1 – Discovery

- Requirements gathering
- Stakeholder workshops
- Current process analysis

Deliverables:

- Business Requirements Document (BRD)
 - Functional Specification
 - Solution Architecture
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Phase 2 – AI Development

Develop AI components capable of:

- OCR processing
 - Document classification
 - Information extraction
 - Cost estimation suggestions
 - Risk identification
 - Natural language search
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Phase 3 – System Integration

Integrate with:

- Microsoft SharePoint
 - Microsoft Teams
 - Outlook
 - ERP system
 - SQL Server database
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Phase 4 – Testing

Supplier shall perform:

- Unit Testing
- Integration Testing
- System Testing
- Performance Testing
- Security Testing
- User Acceptance Testing (UAT)

Testing evidence shall include:

- Test Plans
 - Test Cases
 - Test Results
 - Defect Reports
 - Traceability Matrix
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Phase 5 – Deployment

Activities include:

- Production deployment
 - User training
 - Documentation
 - Hypercare support (30 days)
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5. Functional Requirements

The solution must:

- Support English and Portuguese
 - Process PDF files up to 500 pages
 - Extract tables accurately
 - Detect duplicate requirements
 - Generate editable Word documents
 - Export reports to Excel
 - Provide confidence scores for AI recommendations
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6. Non-Functional Requirements

Requirement	Target
Availability	99.9%

Requirement	Target
Authentication	Microsoft Entra ID
Encryption	AES-256
API Response	<2 seconds
Scalability	500 concurrent users
Audit Logging	Required

7. Deliverables

Supplier shall provide:

- Source Code
 - Technical Documentation
 - API Documentation
 - Deployment Guide
 - User Manual
 - Administrator Manual
 - Training Materials
 - Test Evidence
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8. Supplier Qualifications

Suppliers should demonstrate:

- Minimum 3 years' experience in AI development
 - Experience with Azure or AWS
 - Experience integrating ERP systems
 - Previous public procurement projects preferred
 - ISO 27001 certification desirable
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9. Proposal Submission

Proposals shall include:

Company Information

- Company profile
- Financial statements
- Team structure

Technical Proposal

- Proposed architecture
- Technology stack
- AI models
- Security approach
- Project methodology

Commercial Proposal

- Pricing
- Payment schedule
- Licensing model

Project Plan

- Milestones
- Timeline
- Resource allocation
- Risk management

10. Evaluation Criteria

Criteria	Weight
Technical Solution	40%
Relevant Experience	20%
Project Methodology	15%
Price	20%
Sustainability	5%

11. Project Timeline

Milestone	Target Date
Contract Award	August 2026
Discovery Complete	September 2026
Prototype	November 2026
User Acceptance Testing	January 2027
Go-Live	February 2027

12. Questions

Suppliers may submit clarification questions until five working days before the submission deadline.

All responses will be shared with all participating suppliers.

13. Confidentiality

All documentation provided during this procurement process shall remain confidential and shall only be used for preparing the proposal.

Appendix A – Example User Stories

US-001

As a Budget Engineer

I want the AI to extract quantities from a tender document

So that I can prepare a cost estimate more quickly.

US-002

As a Procurement Officer

I want missing mandatory documents to be highlighted

So that submissions remain compliant.

US-003

As a Project Manager

I want dashboards showing tender progress

So that I can monitor deadlines.

Appendix B – Example Acceptance Criteria

- AI extracts project title correctly.
- AI identifies document language.

- Tables are extracted with $\geq 95\%$ accuracy.
 - Budget estimates can be edited by users.
 - All AI suggestions include confidence scores.
 - Every action is logged in the audit trail.
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Appendix C – Technology Preferences

Preferred technologies include:

- Python
- FastAPI
- Java
- React
- Azure OpenAI
- Microsoft Copilot
- PostgreSQL
- SQL Server
- Docker
- Kubernetes
- GitHub Actions
- REST APIs